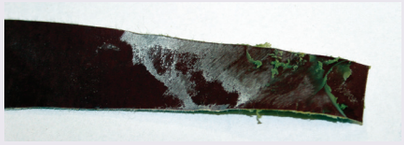
2. WHAT TO LOOK FOR WHEN TURNING A SQUARE EDGE BOWL

There are a few things to consider when turning a square edge item. Timber preparation: you want the piece of timber to be square with all corners as close to 90° as possible, or you will not have a square edge bowl. Close grain timber helps as well; open grain will be more prone to breaking. Speed is very difficult to advise on; this depends on a lot of factors such as experience, size of work, lathe stability and safety, the list can go on. But when you have a piece of square edge timber speed is more important, after a corner has passed your tool the slower your lathe speed is the longer before the next corner comes around and contacts your tool which means less tool control, which in turn means a poor surface finish on your work.

3. WET SANDING

This item is wet sanded on the final grade of abrasives to give a good finish. This is sanding while the oil finish is still wet, the dust and oil mixes to produce grain filler, which fills open grain or any small defects on the surface. You can use wet sanding from the start with the coarse grade abrasives through to the final grade, this reduces the airborne dust in your workshop as well. Can this method be used on any timber? No, this is down to cross-contamination of timber dust, think of yew or laburnum (*Laburnum anagyroides*) where the heartwood is dark but it is surrounded by light coloured sapwood. As you wet sand, the dark heartwood dust and oil slurry can be transmitted into the pores of the sapwood leaving a mottled coloured surface, not a good look. The only way with this type of timber is if all the sapwood has been removed, as in the saucer in this project.



PLANS AND EQUIPMENT

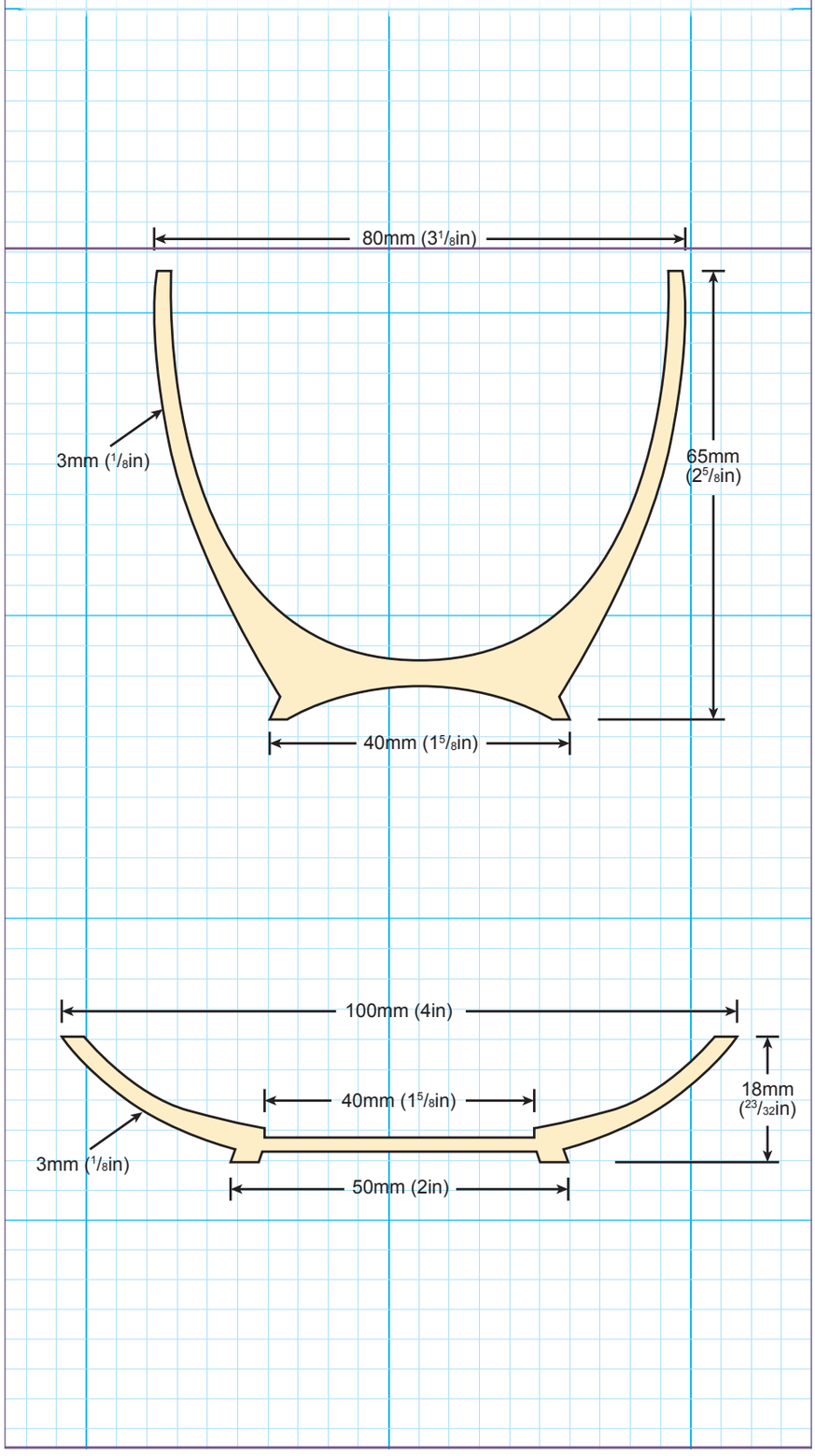
EQUIPMENT USED

Tools required

10mm bowl gouge
25mm French curve scraper
3mm parting tool
20mm skew
10mm spindle gouge with a fingernail profile

Timber requirements

Sycamore (*Acer pseudoplatanus*):
85mm sq x 75mm
Yew (*Taxus baccata*) 100mm sq x 25mm



WT_288_87_91_PHILIP_GREENWOODbdJRmbPGSD.indd 88 30/11/2015 12:39